Jinna Balu

DevOps Solution Architect • SRE Lead

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GitHub LinkedIn

Value Ambassador Award — @ Wisestep, 2020 • Platform Engineering Role

PERSONAL PROFILE

Hands-on DevOps Solution Architect and SRE Lead with 12+ years of experience in cloud infrastructure, distributed systems, and DevSecOps. Skilled in building resilient, observable platforms and collaborating across time zones to support high-performing global engineering teams.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SRE Lead • DevSecOps Architect — Aug 2022 – Present

- Managed **12+ data centers**, each hosting multiple distributed clusters of **Kafka**, **Cassandra**, **MongoDB**, **Solr**, and **ZooKeeper**.
- Modernized legacy single points of failure into highly available, fault-tolerant services across data centers.
- Implemented container orchestration using **DC/OS** (Mesos/Marathon) and **Kubernetes**; led migration of Marathon workloads to Kubernetes using **Helm** charts.
- Configured data center–level high availability using **HAProxy** with **VRRP** and **Keepalived**.
- Enabled global traffic steering using **Cloudflare Load Balancer**; migrated traffic management from Oracle Dyn to **Cloudflare**.
- Designed and implemented centralized logging using **Elasticsearch**, **Logstash**, **Kafka**, and custom agents, processing peak volumes of **~21M logs**; improved query

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Platform Engg
- DevOps
- DevSecOps
- Cloud
- SRE Practices
- Developer
- Team Management
- System Design

SKILLS

CLOUD SERVICES

AWS, Azure, Digital Ocean, IAM, S3, EKS, ECS, EC2, SES, AKS, AGIC, Audit Manager, Security Hub, Config, GuardDuty, Capacity Planning

CONTAINERISATION

Docker, Podman, Docker Swarm, Kubernetes, DC/OS, Mesos, Marathon, Helm

CI/CD & AUTOMATION

Jenkins, Bitbucket Pipelines, Remote Runners, GitLab, GitHub Actions, Ansible, Monorepo, Polyrepo

performance and maintained stable operations with zero reporting issues over one year.

- Implemented infrastructure and uptime monitoring using **Datadog** (with agents) and **Uptime Kuma**.
- Automated infrastructure and service deployments using **Ansible**, supporting containerized (**Docker**/**Podman**) and host-based installations.
- Reduced deployment time and operational overhead by adopting modern automation practices and standardized deployment workflows.
- Introduced **Bitbucket Pipelines** with self-hosted **Remote Runners** for new applications; planning CI/CD migration from **Jenkins** to Bitbucket Pipelines.
- Strengthened DNS monitoring and domain security by implementing controls for subdomain takeover prevention and configuring **SPF**, **DKIM**, and **DMARC** policies.
- Executed zero-downtime **LDAP** migrations (BDB → HDB → MDB), ensuring data integrity and service continuity.
- Worked with **Azure** to build new cloud-based infrastructure; migrated containerized workloads to **AKS**, implemented **Application Gateway (AGIC v2)**, and deployed **Datadog** and logging agents as **DaemonSets**.
- Developed internal tools with AI-enabled capabilities like **Amazon Q**, **Claude**, and **GitHub Copilot**, including:
  - **Spring Boot**–based full-stack status page with **React** (**shadcn/ui**, **Tailwind CSS**) frontend and **Go**-based agents for global latency and synthetic monitoring.
  - Custom **LDAP Manager UI** built with **React**, **shadcn/ui**, and **Tailwind CSS** for simplified directory management and operations.
- Led platform upgrades and continuous improvements to tooling and infrastructure, reducing operational toil and improving system reliability.

DevOps Manager — Apr 2021 – Jul 2022

- Application orchestration with Docker Swarm, ECS, and Kubernetes.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

SOC2, GDPR, PCI DSS, SonarQube, SAST, DAST, Snyk, Trivy, Gitleaks, VAPT, Arachni, SPF, DKIM, DMARC

DNS & LOAD BALANCING

Caddy, NGINX, ALB, ELB, Cloudflare, HAProxy, Keepalived, VRRP

MONITORING & OBSERVABILITY

ELK, Prometheus, Grafana, Beats, Logstash, Datadog, Uptime Kuma

DATA PLATFORMS

PostgreSQL, Cassandra, Elasticsearch, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, Kafka Connect, RabbitMQ, Solr, Apache Nifi, Airflow

LANGUAGES & FRAMEWORKS

Java, Go, C#, Python, Spring Boot, FastAPI, React, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, ASP.NET MVC, AngularJS

SCAFFOLDING & TOOLS

JHipster, Jekyll, Hugo, Yeoman

VERSION CONTROL

Git, Monorepo, Polyrepo, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket

OPERATING SYSTEMS

Ubuntu, Mac, Windows

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Kanban, Scrum, Jira, Trello, Pivotal Tracker

- Distributed cluster management of Cassandra, Elasticsearch, Kafka, and Redis as containers.
- DevSecOps with AWS Audit Manager, Security Hub, Config—maintaining SOC2 compliance.
- Observability driven development with Elasticsearch, Beats, Logstash, and Prometheus Stack.
- Team management with Kanban and Scrum; maintaining error budgets, toil budgets, and overhead in control.
- Created and maintained dev centre for internal domain access to all internal services securely.
- NGINX/Caddy for load balancing and reverse proxy.
- CI/CD with Git and Jenkins; deployment and infra automation with Ansible.
- Scaling Elasticsearch without downtime and data loss; optional disaster recovery with minimal RTO and RPO.
- Managing infrastructure automation, reliability, security, change management, and capacity planning with a team of 2.

Platform Engineer — Wisestep Apr 2019 – Mar 2021

- Building microservices using Spring Boot, containerizing with Docker, deploying to AWS Cloud.
- Application deployment automation with CI/CD and smooth change management.
- Application and infrastructure monitoring.
- Distributed cluster management for NoSQL databases with consistency.
- High availability, consistency, security, and reliability.
- Application performance monitoring and real-time user monitoring.
- AWS solutions for security practices and cost optimizations.
- Vulnerability assessment with open source tools.
- DevOps for release management; building features and handling feature lifecycles for Wisestep, a recruitment platform.

AI-ASSISTED DEVELOPMENT

Amazon Q, Claude, GitHub Copilot

EDUCATION

MCA

JNTU Hyderabad, 2010 - 2013

CGPA 7.5 / 10

BSc, Computer Science

Osmania University, 2007 - 2010

CGPA 6.5 / 10

VOLUNTEER

Gramabharati

Gramavikas

Ekalavya Foundation

Product Development Engineer — Wisestep Sep 2014 – Mar 2019

- Developed and supported custom-built applications; participated in product development.
- Analysis of requirements for user interface, application enhancements, new functionality, and backend processes.
- Code and modify applications using programming tools; document code adhering to naming conventions.
- Created reports and worked on technical and analytical aspects of report creation.
- Participated in unit, system, and user acceptance testing.
- Deployed data science for real-time anomaly detection and diagnosis of high-impact problems using ML.

Project #3: Wisestep ATS — Full Stack Engineer

Crowdsourcing talent from expert global recruitment partners with split fee management. Orchestrated dev and prod environments for microservice applications using JHipster. Application security with OWASP/VAPT using Arachni. Containerization with Docker Swarm, CI/CD with Jenkins and Ansible. AWS parameter store and IAM security. Elasticsearch, Cassandra, and Kafka cluster management.

HTML, CSS, AngularJS, Bootstrap, Thymeleaf, Java, Spring MVC, Elasticsearch, Cassandra, Microservices, JHipster, AWS, Docker, Docker Swarm, NGINX, VAPT

Project #2: Wisestep Pulse — Full Stack Developer

Recruitment Process Management, Timesheet, Contract, and Payments Management application. Worked with individual responsibility from frontend to database—HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, AngularJS, REST APIs with Code First Approach, MSSQL indexing for performance.

ASP.NET MVC, Entity Framework, C#, SQL Server 2008, AngularJS, HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, Gulp, Solr

Project #1: MIS — .NET Developer

Application for managing Recruiters, Jobs, and Candidates Processing for closing client positions. One-man army for building features from coding, designing, and release management. Monitoring, troubleshooting, and deploying to IIS.

ASP.NET Web Application, ASP.NET MVC, Entity Framework, C#, AngularJS, HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, Gulp, Solr, SQL Server 2008